CATHERINE JIE LU

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EDUCATION

McGill University *Montreal, Canada* Sep 2022 – Apr 2027

BA Honours Economics, Minors in Mathematics and Political Science

- Relevant Courses: Research Project 1 (A), Econometrics 2 – Honours (A), Methods of Causal Inference (A), Statistics (A), Political Economy of International Organizations (A-), International Politics (A-)
- Coded Monte Carlo simulations and causal inference frameworks to analyze economic data in MATLAB and STATA
- Tutoring experience in Microeconomics, Economic Statistics, Econometrics

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

McGill University *Montreal, Canada*

ECON 480: Independent Research Project, supervised by Professor Silvia Gonçalves May 2026

- Designed Monte Carlo simulations in MATLAB to compare Local Projections and Vector Autoregression (VAR) methods for impulse response estimation using a first-order autoregressive (AR(1)) framework
- Authored paper titled "*Local Projections vs. VARs: An AR(1) Introduction*" and accompanying code, received an A

ECON 437: Methods of Causal Inference, with guidance from Professor Matthieu Chemin Apr 2026

- Applied a difference-in-differences (DiD) framework to assess the EU–Colombia FTA on firm-reported trade barriers
- Authored paper titled "*Did the Colombia–EU FTA (2013) Reduce Firms' Reported Customs Obstacles?*"; designed 4 control groups and analyzed 12k+ World Bank Enterprise Survey observations in STATA, received an A

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Bikaner Advisors *Montreal, Canada*

Investment Analyst Apr 2025 – Nov 2025

- Built portfolio benchmarking database for $1b+ institutional allocations across 100+ investors and 6 asset classes, saving 30+ hours weekly and enabling team to identify key allocation deviations from benchmarks
- Developed project workflows in Notion, adopted by 100% of team within 2 weeks, reducing meeting time by 30%
- Received return offer to work part-time during school year for exceptional performance and impact

Scotiabank Global Capital Markets *Toronto, Canada*

Sales and Trading Analyst Sep 2023 – Dec 2023

- Led foreign exchange and interest rate options workflow between sales and trading teams, conducting systematic PnL analysis enabling $200k–$2m in revenue recovery across 12+ weekly trade executions
- Developed Excel VBA toolkit for 75+ option structures replacing manual process, saving 60+ hours weekly; standardized PowerPoint template for 12+ trade decks, reducing revision cycles by 50%
- Automated daily FX market emails from Bloomberg to 60+ team members, generating $500k+ in estimated revenue

LEADERSHIP EXPERIENCE

McGill Model United Nations Assembly (McMUN) *Montreal, Canada*

Chargée d'Affaires Jun 2024 – Jan 2025

- Led end-to-end registration for McMUN, Canada's largest and top-ranked Model UN conference, reducing error rates by 500% and delivering a scalable system for 1.6k+ attendees
- Automated operational logistics, consolidating a three-person task into one and reducing workload by 400%

Deputy Under Secretary-General, Specialized Committees Sep 2023 – Jan 2024

- Directed 30+ conference staff, ensuring high quality of writing and operational consistency across 7 teams
- Oversaw feedback mechanisms for 300+ conference attendees, enabling improvements in conference delivery

SKILLS AND INTERESTS

- Languages: English (Fluent), French (Intermediate), Mandarin Chinese (Intermediate), Russian (Elementary)
- Skills: Python, R, MATLAB, STATA, Excel (VBA/Modeling), PowerPoint, Bloomberg Terminal
- Awards: 1st Place – BOLT Case Competition (2025), 1st Place – UC Berkeley Model United Nations Conference (2024)